IMPERIAL PARLIAMENT.

In the HOUSE OF LORDS, August 20, the Royal assent was given by Commission to a large number of Acts, most of which were private.

The report of amendments in the Patents for Inventions Bill was received.

The Education (Scotland) Bill was read a second time.

On the motion for going into Committee on the Parliamentary Elections (Corrupt and Illegal Practices) Bill,

Lord Salisbury observed that as the Bill would expire at the end of next year, he would at present offer no amendments, but he reserved to himself the right to do so when it was proposed to make the measure a permanent Act.

Committee on the Bill was then taken, and the latter, with some amendments introduced by the Government, was subsequently reported to the House

Their lordships having gone into Committee on the Bankruptcy Bill, a very large number of verbal amendments, proposed by the Lord Chancellor, were adopted without discussion, and the Bill as amended, was reported to the House

The remaining orders having been disposed of, their lordships adjourned at a quarter past seven o'clock.

COLONIAL DEFENCES.

In the HOUSE OF COMMONS Sir G. Campbell asked the Under-Secretary of State for the Colonies whether it was understood that the colonies having what was called responsible government had the power to raise military and naval forces without reference to the Government in England; whether they could order armed sea-going vessels without such reference; and whether the Colony of Queensland had actually done so.

Mr Ashley said, in reply: The colonies under responsible government are expected to provide for their own internal defence. They have in some cases, as Canada and the Cape, large military forces, and in the case of the Australian colonies armed ships. The colonies can order armed sea-going ships without special reference to her Majesty's Government in each case. The Colony of Queensland includes the islands within 60 miles of the mainland, and with the full approval of her Majesty's Government, are providing efficient small vessels for the defence of the colony.

EXHIBITION OF THE ROYAL ARMS.

Mr. Arnold asked Solicitor-General, with reference t Clause 106 of the Patents for Inventions Bill, imposing a penalty not exceeding £20 upon the unauthorized assumption of the Royal Arms, whether engravers and designers who produced, and tradesmen who, for loyalty and ornament, displayed the Royal Arms on trade labels, shop fronts, paper bags, and in other ways, but without any word or words implying that they made such assumption by authority, would efree from liability,

The Solicitor-General said a person displaying the Royal Arms under the circumstances mentioned would not render himself liable to the penalty provided by the clause.

MADAGASCAR.

Sir S. Northcote asked the First Lord of the Treasury when he would be prepared to make a statement with respect to Madagascar; and whether he could now give the House any particulars with respect to a proclamation said to have been issued by "the Superior Commandant of Tamatave,' prohibiting access to Tamatave "to all foreign sailors, soldiers, and officers."

Mr. Gladstone stated that he was not yet sure that the French Government were in possession of all the information in detail relating to events in Madagascar. As to a proclamation said to have been issued by the Superior Commandant at Tamatave prohibiting access to Tamatave of foreign sailors, soldiers, and officers, it was not limited to the officers, &c., of any particular vessel, or the representatives of a particular nationality, but included all foreign sailors, soldiers, and officers. With regard to the case of Mr. Shaw, it appeared from the statement of the French Consul at Zanzibar, who had been at Tamatave, that Mr. Shaw was not actually imprisoned, but was on board a French vessel, of which he had free range. The nature of the charge against him was that of communicating with the enemy, and directing hostile action towards the French soldiers. Under French law he would be tried by court-martial, with power of appeal to a Court of Revision, and there was no reason to suppose that he would not have every facility for his defence.

Sir S. Northcote observed that the answer of the right hon. gentleman was far short of what the House might expect, and he intimated that he should repeat his question.

Mr. Gladstone replied that he should give no further answer. He could not do so without breach of duty and injury to the public interest.

Sir S. Northcote pointed out that all he wished to know was as to the state of the facts.

Mr. Gladstone said it would be impossible to give a particular account of the facts without entering into the detail of intricate correspondence, which it would be injurious and premature to lay before Parliament at the present moment.

THE SUEZ CANAL.

In reply to Sir S. Northcote, Mr. Gladstone said there were no negotiations in progress with M. de Lesseps or the Suez Canal Company respecting the improvement of the transit by the canal, or the formation of a second canal; and the Government had no desire for a very early resumption of the negotiations. They hoped that the representatives of the trading interests of this and other countries would communicate their views to the authorities of the Canal Company.

THE PIGEON SHOOTING BILL.

Mr. Anderson gave notice that it was his intention next session to reintroduce his Bill for the Amendment of the Cruelty to Animals Acts.

SUPPLY.

On the order for considering the Report of the Committee of Supply, Sir J. Hay called attention to the evidence given before the Joint Committee on the Channel Tunnel by Lord Wolseley and Admiral Rice, concerning the defenceless state of the country, more especially as regarded the insufficiency of ironclads and guns.

The discussion was continued by Sir E. J. Reed, Sir G. Balfour, Sir H. Holland, and the Secretary to the Admiralty.

A division was taken against the Report, but was defeated by 99 to 12.

A Motion of Mr. Healy to reduce the expenses of the Chief Secretary's office by the amount of the Chief Secretary's salary was rejected by 97 to 12.

A Motion to reduce the Vote for the Local Government Board of Ireland by £500, the salary of the inspector of the Donegal Workhouse, was negatived by 75 to 13.

On the resolution relating to the vote for martial law Mr. Maxwell-Heron called attention to the finding of the court-martial in the case of his brother, the commander of the *Clyde*, and urged that the court in condemning him had been guilty of an error of judgment. Reviewing the evidence given before the court, he contended that it was both untrustworthy and uncorroborated, and appealed to the justice and clemency of the Government to grant a reconsideration of the case.

Sir John Hay and Colonel Alexander having warmly joined in this appeal, Mr. Campbell-Bannerman declined to regard the House as a court of review, and defended the course taken by the Admiralty in the matter.

The report of Supply was completed, and the Appropriation Bill was read a first time.

The House adjourned at a quarter to three o'clock.

In the HOUSE OF LORDS, Aug. 21, the Corrupt Practices (Suspension of Elections) Bill was read a second time.

The second reading of the Parliamentary Registration (Ireland) Bill was moved by Lord Carlingford.

Lord Kilmorey protested against the growing practice of sending important Bills to that House at the end of the Session.

Lord Granville pointed out that in the other House no objection had been urged against either the principle or the details of the measure.

Lord Salisbury remarked that the grounds for rejecting the Bill were strong.

A vision was taken resulting in the rejection of the Bill by 52 to 32.

Lord Dalhousie having moved the second reading of the Local Government (Scotland) Bill a discussion ensued.

Lord Salisbury had no prejudice against the principles of the Bill, but contended that it was neither for the interests of the country nor respectful to Scotland that such a measure should be passed in this hurried manner.

Their lordships divided, and threw out the Bill by 46 to 31.

The Tramways and Public Companies (Ireland) Bill, and the Public Works Loans Bill were read a second time; the Labourers (Ireland) Bill passed through committee; and the Patents for Inventions Bill and several other measures were read a third time and passed.

At a few minutes to eight their lordships adjourned during pleasure to await the return of the Agricultural Bills from the Commons.

In the HOUSE OF COMMONS a new writ was ordered for the election of a member for Rutland in the room of the Right Hon. G. Noel, resigned.

Mr. Gladstone, answering questions from Sir G. Campbell and Sir M. Hicks-Beach, stated that the Government had abandoned all hope of passing the Criminal Appeal Bill, and the Bill was therefore withdrawn.

In reply to Sir M. Hicks-Beach, Mr. Ashley said the Government had received official information that Cetewayo is located in the Reserve Territory; and Mr. Gladstone stated that instructions had been or would be immediately sent out to prevent his making use of the Reserve Territory as a basis of military operations.

THE RESULTS OF THE SESSION.

On the Second Reading of the Appropriation Bill,

Sir S. Northcote took the opportunity of making some remarks on the legislation of the session and the general position of the country. Reminding the House that it had sat in 17 out of the last 19 months, and that during the last few months the sittings had been very prolonged, he pointed out that notwithstanding the assistance of the New Rules the legislatives results had been very limited, for out of 11 measures mentioned in the Queen's Speech 8 had been abandoned. This result he attributed in a great measure to the want of proper management of business and economy of time, and to the sudden introduction of uncalled-for measures like the Affirmation Bill, the Scotch Local Government Bill, and the Irish Registration Bill. In regard to the foreign and colonial relations of the country, Parliament, he said, was separating under circumstances of considerable anxiety. The House did not know what the real intentions of the Government were in regard to Egypt or the Suez Canal, and in South Africa and India there was a group of questions which must excite great uneasiness. The reticence of the Government as to events in Madagascar created an impression that there was something wrong behind, and it was quite impossible to accept Mr. Gladstones contention that information could not be given until the papers were published. In Afghanistan it was evident that the policy of abstentation was being abandoned, and that we were now making ourselves masters of the foreign policy of the country. With regard to India, he said that, though favourable to the introduction of natives into the public employment, he held that the feelings of the Europeans in India must be considered, and overhaste would retard the aim all had in view.

Mr. Gladstone explained that there were thirteen measures propounded in the Speech from the Throne, and that five of the number had been passed during the Session, and he maintained that, with the exception of the London Government Bill, which it was impossible for Ministers to undertake, those five measures were of a more weighty and important character than those which had not been passed. Replying next to the criticisms of Sir Stafford on the Foreign and Colonial policy of the Government, he reiterated his formerly expressed views relating to Egypt and the Suez Canal. As to Afghanistan, the Government had found it broken to pieces. They had done something towards its restoration, and the state of that country would in future depend on the power and capacity of its own people, and not on any foreign tyranny. In reference to Madagascar he said now, as he said at first, that though there were matters which ought to be frankly and calmly discussed between the two Governments, nothing had occurred, so far as his judgment went, to disturb the minds of many—and he thanked God they were many—of those who set a high value on the alliance between France and England. At the same time he protested against the manner in which questions had been addressed to Ministers in the House as constituting a serious danger.

The Debate was protracted until ten minutes to eleven o'clock, when the second reading was agreed to without division.

THE AGRICULTURAL HOLDINGS BILL.

The House then took up the Lords' amendments to the English Agricultural Holdings Bill.

The first amendment considered was the Duke of Richmond's, extending the provision as to the inherent capability of the soil to all classes of improvements; and Mr. Dodson proposed to agree with it.

This was objected to by Mr. J. Howard, Mr. Barclay, and others, but on a division it was agreed to by 121 to 64.

The next amendment was Lord Salisbury's to Clause 2, providing that no compesation shall be claimed in contravention of any specific agreement at present existing between the landlord and tenant; and Mr. Dobson proposed to disagree with the Lords in this.

After a protest from Sir M. Hicks-Beach, the amendment was negatived without a division.

The Lords' amendments relating to landlord's compensation for waste, to the rate per cent. to be charged for expenditure or drainage, and to the compensation for feeding stuffs and manure were disagreed to, a division being taken on this last point—126 to 51.

The amendment extending the right of distress to two years was also negatived without any division, as were also the amendments fixing the date of the commencement of the Act at Lady Day, instead of January 1, 1884, and the limitation of the Act to holdings over two acres.

Subsequently the Lords' amendments to the Scotch Agricultural Holdings Bill were considered.

Several other Bills were forwarded a stage, and the House adjourned at five minutes to three o'clock.

In the HOUSE OF LORDS, August 22, the Revenue and Friendly Societies Bill was read a second time, and, after a short discussion, the Standing Orders were suspended, and the measure was passed through Committee and was read a third time.

The National Debt Bill, the Corrupt Practices Bill, the Education (Scotland) Bill, and the Expiring Laws Continuance Bill were read a third time and passed.

SCHOOL BOARD AND HOME LESSONS.

Lord Stanley of Alderley asked the Lord President whether School Boards had any legal right to exact home lessons and to dispose of the time of children attending Board Schools out of school hours; and, if so, under what section of what Act of Parliament.

Lord Carlingford said he had no authority, as President of the Council, to determine the legal rights of School Boards in this matter.

THE AGRICULTURAL HOLDINGS BILL.

On the consideration of the Commons' amendments to their lordships' amendments to the Agricultural Holdings (England) Bill, Lord Carlingford pointed out that all the changes which their lordships had made in the Bill were more or less in restriction of the benefits intended to be conferred upon the farmers. On the recommendation of the Government, the Lower House had agreed to two of these, but with respect to the others the Government believed they were quite unnecessary for the protection of the landlord, and would have a prejudicial effect on the success of the measure. He therefore asked their lordships not to insist upon the amendments to which the Commons had disagreed.

The Marquis of Salisbury reminded the noble lord that the Opposition had made large concessions in assenting to the main principles of the Bill, and moved the insertion of words providing that no compensation should be paid to the tenant where any agreement fixing the rent had been entered into upon the expressed or implied condition that the tenant should execute the improvements.

In the course of the discussion which ensued, the Earl of Kimberley said he hoped the noble marquis would not persevere with an amendment which was wholly unnecessary, and would endanger the Bill.

The Duke of Richmond, as a member of the Royal Commission on Agriculture, objected to the amendment, and added that nothing could be more disastrous than that anything should be done by that House to jeopordise the passing of the Bill.

In the course of further discussion, the Earl of Derby remarked that it was not in the interest of Conservative peers, either politically or as landowners, to insist on their amendments.

Ultimately Lord Salisbury's Motion was carried by 49 to 48.

The other amendments, to which the Commons had disagreed, were not insisted on; and after inserting in the Agricultural Holdings (Scotland) Bill, at the instance of the Earl of Galloway, a proviso similar to that of the Marquis of Salisbury in the English Bill, their lordships rose at ten minutes to nine o'clock.

In the HOUSE OF COMMONS, the Speaker took the chair at twenty minutes past twelve. It was found necessary to light the Chamber at the beginning of the sitting.

Mr. Jesse Collings gave notice that early next session he would move a resolution affirming the desirability of granting a measure of Home Rule to Ireland, as the best means of securing permanent peace in that country.

The Appropriation Bill passed through Committee.

THE INDIAN BUDGET.

Mr. J. K. Cross made his annual Budget statement on Indian finance. For the year 1882-3 there had been a surplus of revenue over expenditure, notwithstanding the expenditure on the Egyptian campaign, and a million and a half laid aside for famine relief and insurance. He estimated a surplus of nearly half a million for the current year. The taxation of the inhabitants under our direct rule would average about fourteen and a half annas per head in the year ending March next. The hon. gentleman took a hopeful view of the condition of the people and of the trade and industry of India. Having analysed the principal items of revenue and expenditure, the hon. gentleman advocated a policy of careful extension of productive public works in India, and stated that during the current year it was proposed to expend six million sterling upon railway construction.

A discussion ensued, and at twenty-five minutes to six the debate was adjourned.

The House adjourned at five minutes to six.

SINGULAR DISCOVERY OF DEAD BODIES.

In London, on Wednesday, a horrible discovery was made by the police at the shop of an undertaker, carrying on business in Bermondsey. In consequence of information received, Sergeant Pickles proceeded to the shop at an early hour on Wednesday morning, and discovered in a shell the dead bodies of nine children, some of the remains being in an advanced stage of decomposition. Upon further search, another shell, containing three dead bodies, was discovered in a similar condition. The remains were removed to St. George's Mortuary. A full investigation will be made. The divisional surgeon is of opinion that the bodies must have been secreted several months. The proprietor of the business has been in communication with the police, and, in the light of his statement, it is not believed that any more serious charge than that of creating a public nuisance will arise out of the discovery. According to the caretaker who resides on the premises with his wife it is no unusual thing for bodies of stillborn infants to be brought to the shop and remain there until a number have accumulated, when they are buried *en bloc*. It appears that a very small charge is made for the interment of such corpses, and it is alleged that the undertaker could not recoup himself unless this course were adopted. The bodies brought to light are all those of infants bearing every indication of having been stillborn.

CUTTINGS FROM AMERICAN PAPERS

A little girl hearing her mother observe to another, lady that she was going into half-mourning, inquired whether any of her relations were half dead.

"Is your vessel your home?" asked a lady, addressing a man-of-war's man. "It is, ma'am," replied the seaman, "in times of peace, but when we're in close action we're only boarders."

A writer in a scientific monthly asks: "What is a meter?" An opinion has long prevailed that a meter is a contrivance that works twenty-seven hours a day eight days a week the year round; and when you resolve to economise in the use of gas it throws in a couple of extra hours daily without charge.

"No, madam," remarked the museum man, as a large, portly woman stepped up, "the egress ain't in there." "Well, sure, there's the craytur's name Why don't ye take down the sign if he's out."

City boarder to farm-hand: "Why does that odd-looking fowl make that curious noise?" "That rooster that jest crowed? Oh, that's jest a way he has, ma'am, of signifyin' that he's a high flyer from up the creek, and that he is happy because he ain't old enough by eleven years to make a pot-pie for summer boarders."

The value of the exports of produce from the United States during last week amounted to 8,374,000 dols., this being the largest amount reached any week this year with one exception.

It is probable that an Agricultural Department will soon be established in Bengal. The Lieutenant-Governor proposes to begin with a school and farm on the Government estate at Nazirgunge, in Shahabad. The school is intended to be used for the training of managers for the estates of Government wards.

The Italian criminal statistics for the second quarter of the current year show that crimes against the person, murders, &c., have increased by 1,181, while offences touching property show a diminution of 1,785.

THE WALTHAMSTOW TRAGEDY.

COMMITTAL OF THE PRISONER.

At the Stratford Petty Sessions on Saturday, in the Court-house of the Half-Hundred of Beacontree Division, William Gouldstone, 26, of 8, Courtenay-place, St. James's-street, Walthamstow, was again brought up on the charge of murdering his five children on the 8th inst., at his residence, under circumstances already reported. At the inquest held on the previous Monday the jury returned a verdict of "Wilful murder" against the prisoner.

Mr. Batcheler, from the office of the Solicitor to the Treasury, now appeared to prosecute on behalf of the Public Prosecutor; and Mr. Atkinson, solicitor, watched the case for the prisoner.—We take the following report of the evidence from *The Times* of Monday:—

Mrs. Ada Hamilton, the nurse to Mrs. Gouldstone in her confinement, and who had already given evidence, was again called, and, cross examined by Mr. Atkinson, she simply added to her previous statement that after August 1 (when Mrs. Gouldstone was confined of twins) the prisoner appeared to be in a desponding state and absent-minded. He would come in and sit down, but seldom speak. She had never heard him complain of being short of money, or of being unable to support his children. He was very kind to his wife, and she never heard him speak a cross word to her. She had never heard the wife say that she wished the children dead. Prisoner did not say anything to her on the Sunday before this occurrence that he felt a fit of kleptomania coming over him. When he was sitting on the fire-guard with his back to the fire he was twirling a bit of cord in his hands. He was not gazing absently into the fire. There might have been a slip noose in the cord at the time, but she did not notice it. She had not seen him going about muttering to himself since August 1. When she saw him carrying the first child from the washhouse to the kitchen he seemed very excited, not absent or wandering.

Police-constable Cheeseman, 86 N, was next recalled, and having repeated that he was called to the house of the prisoner at the time of the murder, said: I went into the prisoner's kitchen—they live upstairs—and saw three children lying on the floor there. The prisoner was standing over them in a stooping position. He had his hat and coat off, his shirt sleeves being tucked up. The children's clothes appeared to be drenched with water; they were thoroughly wet. When the prisoner saw me, he said, "Good evening, policeman; I have done it; now I am happy and ready for the rope." I cautioned him, telling him that whatever he said would be used in evidence against him. Having put on his hat and coat he asked me to let him see his wife, and I then took him into the bedroom. His wife said, "Oh, you wicked man; what have you done?" and he replied, "I have killed all your children, you will be single again and I shall be hanged." She then asked him for some money, and he gave her all he had. He then kissed his wife, wished her "good-bye," and I took him away from the house. On the road to the police-station prisoner said "When I took my money last week I thought of buying a revolver to do it with, but I altered my mind, as I thought it would make too much noise. I had a hard job with the two biggest, but the other little ——, I soon settled him. I thought it was getting too hot. I have had five —— kids in three years and-a-half, so I thought it was time to put a step to it." At the station prisoner said "I did it like a man," and when he was charged he remarked "Quite right, Sir." When I saw the three children at the house I satisfied myself that they were dead.

Cross-examined, witness said prisoner seemed excited at the time, but not from drink. When he spoke about being ready for the rope, he did not have a piece of cord in his hand. He did not hear Mrs. Gouldstone remark in her bedroom that she wished the children were dead. As a matter of fact the whole of the children at that time were not dead. It was at the station prisoner said "Quite right, Sir." He made no mention about not having money to support the children. The wife made no reply whatever when he said he had murdered all her children.

Police-constable Honey, 41 N Reserve, and Inspector Folkard, repeated the evidence they had previously given, the latter adding that he had examined the cistern. The top of it was about 6ft. from the floor, and 10in. from the ceiling. It was 14in. deep.

Police-constable Wheatley, 208 N, stationed at Lea-bridge-road, said: At about a quarter to seven o'clock on the evening of the 8th inst., I was in a passage at the station, leading to the cell where the prisoner was. He said to me, "I have had an extra drop of drink to-day to accomplish this job. There's five of them gone to glory, and it is a good job too." At half-past seven o'clock he said, "I am sorry for my wife and parents, but the children will be better off in Heaven, if there is such a place. It is better than leaving them to the mercy of the world." At about nine o'clock he said, "I wish I had killed the little ones out of the way. I do not know if I hit them once or twice. I have had this preying on my mind for a long time."

By Mr. Atkinson: He volunteered these statements. He was under my immediate observation all the time. I did not hear him rambling or mumbling to himself. I observed no traces of drink about him. I did not in the least observe any strangeness about him; he was very cool.

Mr. Henry Gould, M.R.C.S., L.A.S. Lond., the divisional surgeon of police for the district, said: On the 8th inst., at about six o'clock, I was called by Inspector Folkard, and went with him to 8, Courtenay-place. I went into the front room on the first floor, and on a bed saw two male children, only a few days old. I examined them, and found they had both received injuries to the head. I felt that the skull of each was fractured, and that blood and froth was issuing from them. I saw it was impossible that they could live. In the kitchen I saw three children lying side by side, quite dead. I saw no marks of violence on two of them, but on the eldest I found an indentation mark of a stout cord that had been put around the neck. At seven the same evening one of the infants died, and the next morning when I went to the house about seven o'clock I found the other had succumbed. Since then I have made a *post-mortem* examination. As to the two younger children, I found that death had been caused by the violence that fractured the skull. As to the three others, they died from suffocation caused by drowning. All the bodies of the children were well nourished.

By Mr. Atkinson: I have only seen the prisoner in connection with this case. I should not like to say that I am perfectly acquainted with the "Cyclopædia of Practical Medicine."

Mr. Atkinson (to Mr. Wells, the clerk): I have a long extract, will you take it down?

Mr. Wells: It is scientific evidence, I presume. I wait the order of the Bench.

Dr. Gould said he was afraid that he was not well up in questions of insanity, to which, he presumed, the questions referred, as it was a speciality.

Mr. Batcheler said that, as Mr. Wells had remarked, insanity was not a question for the consideration of this Court; if information were wanted by Mr. Atkinson he could have evidence produced at the trial.

Mr. Atkinson said he only desired to get a few words on the depositions before the case went before a Judge and jury. He was in the hands of the Bench, however, and if they dissented, he would have to get the questions put through counsel at another place.

The Bench having dissented to the cross-examination,

Mr. Batcheler said this was his case.

Dr. Gould was, however, re-called by Mr. Lister, and in reply to a question, said he was not aware if any means had been taken to restore animation in the three children, Dr. Twining had been at the house before him.

The prisoner was then committed to take his trial at the Central Criminal Court, reserving his defence.

THE CROWN OF ASHANTEE.

Advices from Cape Coast Castle to July 29th, state that the British Government mission to Ashantee has proved very successful, and a sanguinary civil war among the Ashantees has been averted. The roads are again open and trade is coming in freely from the interior to the coast, and the result of the mission is regarded by the local European and native merchants as very satisfactory. The recent disturbance broke out owing to Mensah, the ex-King, wishing to renew the former barbarous customs and public sacrifices of large numbers of his victims. Against this the Ashantees rebelled, and Mensah was deposed and confined under guard twenty miles from Coomassie. The difficulty now is as to the succession of the kingship. There are two claimants, one of whom is Coffee Kalkali. The matter is in the hands of Sir Samuel Rowe, Governor of the Gold Coast, who takes a deep interest in the question. His Excellency takes every means to convince the inland tribes of the vast superiority of commerce and civilisation to wars and barbarous customs. Coffee Kalkali is regarded as the exponent of the war party, and he is not, therefore, likely to be recognised as Mensah's successor. He has been secluded ever since his defeat by Sir Garnet Wolseley, and his reappearance was quite unexpected.

The fifth congress for the study of the history and ethnology of America before its discovery by Columbus was opened at Copenhagen on Tuesday. Among those present was the Princess of Wales.

EPITOME OF NEWS.

BRITISH AND FOREIGN.

Princess Louise will, as at present arranged, leave Quebec for England early in September, and Lord Lorne will follow as soon as possible.

The Russian Government is organising at Kharkoff an exhibition of sheep, to which foreign exhibitors will be admitted. It will be held in 1884.

The fishing at Wick was remarkably heavy on Wednesday, 15,000 crans of herring being landed. The total catch for the season is now a little over 100,000 crans. The average per boat is higher at this period than in any previous year.

A society is being formed under the auspices of a number of Radical members of Parliament for the purpose of promoting the "political education" of the agricultural labourer, in view of the probable extention of household suffrage to the counties.

The St. Gothard Railroad, which cost about £8,000,000, in the first eleven months it was open, ending with April last, earned £358,000 gross and £198,600 net. The largest earnings of any months were £40,540 in September.

Intelligence has just been received from Iceland at Lerwick stating that the cod fishing there this season has been almost a failure. Several smacks attempted to proceed as far as the North Cape, but were prevented from doing so by barriers of ice. The Shetland fleet is expected home about the end of September.

The leaders of the telegraph strike in America have issued an official announcement to the effect that the movement has proved a failure.

Many experiments have recently been made in the cultivation of the tea plant in the United States, and generally with excellent results. In California the plant has been cultivated with considerable success.

According to the latest returns foot-and-mouth disease is spreading in Lincolnshire, 129 animals having on Wednesday been reported by the local inspector as having been attacked near Louth. Fresh outbreaks are also reported in Derbyshire.

A Reuter's telegram, dated Wiesbaden, August 22, says:—"The King of Greece has left here for Homburg on a visit to the Prince of Wales. His Majesty will subsequently proceed to Copenhagen."

A serious fire broke out in a block of warehouses in Maddrell-street, Liverpool, on Wednesday afternoon. The building was of five stories, four containing 3,000 to 4,000 bales of cotton, the basement and top story being stored with olive oil and other produce. The damage is estimated at £40,000.

A collision has occurred on a railway in Kentucky, a train running into the last car of another train at a crossing. The collision caused the explosion of 400 kegs of giant powder, whereby the station was wrecked and the engine blown to atoms. The body of the engine-driver was not found, and there were several persons killed or injured.

A despatch from Smyrna reports the capture of four brigand chiefs. Their bands were completely broken up and dispersed, leaving many of their members dead on the scene of action. A large number of prisoners are in the hands of the authorities.

The Balloon Society, after hearing an address from Captain Molesworth, has resolved that it is absolutely necessary for the growing commerce between East and West that a canal should be made by way of the River Jordan and the Dead Sea from the Mediterranean to the Red Sea.

Christ Church, Kensington, Liverpool, was forcibly entered during Sunday night. Some offertory boxes were broken open and the contents stolen. The thieves also drank two bottles of sacramental wine.

Among the victims at Casamicciola were a Signor and Signora Bonavita, who left property worth 5,000,000f., to which there is no direct heir. Their relations, in order to determine the succession, have petitioned to have the bodies disinterred, that by an examination of the external injuries it may be ascertained who died first.

The returns issued on Wednesday show that on the last day of the first week of August 50,145 indoor and 34,291 outdoor paupers were relieved in the metropolis, making a total of 84,436, as compared with 85,749 on the corresponding date last year, 84,383 in 1881, and 82,681 in 1880. The number of vagrants relieved on the same date was 484.

Late on Tuesday night the flour mills of Mr. Benjamin Harman, at Kiverstown, near Killucan, county Westmeath, were totally destroyed by fire. The loss is estimated at £35,000, and is partly covered by insurance. Three persons were on the premises when the fire broke out, and are supposed to have perished.

The German steamer *Neko* arrived at Rio Janeiro on the 29th ult. with the Spanish steamer *Claris* in tow, having met her on the 25th disabled and ungovernable. The *Claris* was bound from Barcelona for Buenos Ayres, and had about 200 persons on board.

On Wednesday morning a carter named Charles Hersey, together with the horse and cart of which he was in charge, were swept away by the tide at Chiswick draw-lock. He was watering his horse, and, it is supposed, went too far. His body was recovered. The horse and cart were found about a mile down the Thames.

At Lincoln on Monday, an inquest was held on the body of a child, aged three and a-half years, named Walter Walker, son of a foundryman, which was missed on Sunday. On a search being instituted the mother found it heels upwards in a swill-tub, quite dead. A verdict of accidentally suffocated was returned.

The Directors of the Florida Ship Canal and Transit Company have approved the report of the chief engineer, which estimates the cost of a canal $137\frac{1}{2}$ miles long, allowing the passage of two steamers of the first class, at 46,000,000 dols. It will save a distance between New Orleans and Liverpool of 412 miles.

An "Allotments Extension Association" is being formed to aid in carrying out the new Act which directs that the Trustees of Charity Lands left in trust for the benefit of the poor shall offer such lands in allotments, not exceeding one acre each, to labourers and others who may apply for them.

The disease known as "pink eye" has again made its appearance in Yorkshire, and is creating much alarm amongst stud owners and horse breeders in the country.

At Yeadon, near Leeds, on Wednesday, a man named Albert Luty, of Dennison, was killed while playing cricket. He was batting, and a ball rising sharply from the pitch struck him a severe blow on the temple, to which he succumbed.

The annual sale of the Affington flock of pure bred Shropshire rams and ewes, the property of Mr. John Evans, took place on Wednesday at Affington, Shrewsbury, when some very high prices were realised. One ram, Royal Hero, was sold for 115 guineas, and 12 others averaged £50 each.

The official statistics of the foreign trade of France from the 1st of January to the 31st of July, 1883, show that the total of the imports amounts to 2,801,634,000f. which, compared with the same period last year, is an increase of 58,313,000f. The exports amount to 1,953,304,000f, which is, compared with the first seven months of last year, a decrease of 50,077,000f.

It is computed that at least £300,000 changed hands during last week in the sales of Hampshire Down sheep in Wilts. They have been bought for distant parts of England, and even for Germany. The best draft ewes have gone up to as high as 164s. per head.

A case of attempted murder and suicide occurred at North Shields on Tuesday. Thomas Mendigove, a musician, while in bed, was stabbed by his wife, who afterwards attempted to kill herself in the same way. A policeman on entering the room, found both husband and wife bleeding profusely. He sent for the police surgeon, who dressed the wounds, both parties being in a precarious condition.

A Reuter's telegram, dated Tunis, August 18, says:—"The English steamer *Ariel*, from Girgenti to London, laden with esparto and sulphur, which entered the Goeletta roadstead yesterday with her cargo on fire, was sunk by cannon shots during the night in three fathoms of water, no fire engine being available to extinguish the flames."

The *Chimborazo*, which has just arrived at Plymouth from Australia, brought 5,100 carcases of sheep and lambs in refrigerators. The meat is said to be in good condition.

On Friday in last week a miner named John Jones, sixty years of age, residing in Daisy Bank, near Bilston, leaped down a disused pit shaft in Bilston, of the depth of 136 yards, at the bottom of which were 32 feet of water. Before leaping he pulled off his coat and hat, and deliberately walked towards the mouth. When just getting over the fencing he was seized by a passer by, but shook him off, and jumped. The mangled body was afterwards recovered.

The Blue Book containing a return of the judicial rents fixed during May shows that the Sub-Commissioners fixed judicial rents in 3,954 cases, involving a total reduction of rent from £68,989 7s. $9\frac{1}{2}$d. to £55,015 1s. $3\frac{1}{2}$d. During the same period the Irish Civil Bill Courts dealt with 161 cases, reducing the rent total from £4,119 5s. 3d. to £3,318 14s. 7d.

A most glaring case of brigandage in Turkey was recently reported. From the particulars since received it appears that upwards of a hundred men made a descent on Florian, about six hours from Salonica, and captured the Governor, the Cadi, and all the members of the Council which happened to be sitting. A ransom of £20,000 is demanded.

The smoke of the engine on the Green Mountain Railway at Mount Desert can be seen on a clear day from Belfast, forty-five miles distant.

According to a Lorraine newspaper, it is intended to collect the scattered bones of all those Germans who fell in the battles around Metz and to deposit them in one huge ossuary, with a suitable monument.

The *Duke of Devonshire*, Captain Long, left Plymouth for Queensland, on Saturday, with the following emigrants:—157 single men, 223 families, and 94 single women; making a total of 571 souls, equal to 474 adults.

The half-yearly reports of the working of the New York City Savings' Banks show that there are 593,000 depositors, owning deposits of over 232,000,000 dols. in amount. The total sum of the deposits has increased since the preparation of the report by 6,000,000 dols.

Since March 1 to date Chicago packers have slaughtered 1,084,000 hogs, against 1,192,000 for the corresponding period of 1882.

New York Bay is at present full of sharks. The oldest of the fishermen cannot remember any summer when these ugly visitors were so numerous or so large.

Last Saturday being the anniversary of the battle of Lincelles, which was fought on August 18, 1793 (when the English and Dutch defeated the French), the usual custom of decking the colours with laurel was observed in the three regiments of Guards which took part in the engagement under General Lake.

A fire broke out at the offices of the Southern Railway Station in Madrid, early on Sunday morning. The building suffered great damage and the archives were destroyed, but the station itself escaped untouched.

The question of draining the Zuyder Zee is now warmly agitated in the Netherlands, and during the International Exhibition at Amsterdam a meeting of the Royal Institution of Engineers will be held, at which plans and projects will be considered for closing the channels between the well-known islands.

In Newcastle and Gateshead a movement has taken shape for the construction of another high-level bridge over the Tyne, at a cost of from £150,000 to £200,000.

A man named Granger, who claimed to have served in the 54th Regiment at Waterloo, died on Sunday at Springfield, Long Island, aged ninety-four.

Sir Charles Tupper, High Commissioner for Canada, has received the following telegram from the Minister of Agriculture:—"Total immigrants arrived in the Dominion to end of July 72,281, against 59,939 same date last year. Labour still much wanted."

M. Leon Poirier, of the Paris Geographical Society, has left to that institution the third part of his large fortune for the endowment of research.

At the Royal Observatory, Greenwich, the mean temperature last week was 62·3deg., which is identical with the average in the corresponding week of the last twenty years.

Sir Moses Montefiore has sent to each of the fifteen Jews recently acquitted in the Nyiregyhaza case a letter exhorting them to remain faithful subjects of their country. Each letter contained a £10 note.

The greater part of the village of Bersezio, in Italy, has been destroyed by fire. The flames spread so rapidly that before they could be extinguished forty-four dwellings had been entirely destroyed, besides other damage done. A woman was burnt to death, and three other persons sustained severe injuries.

Several German gentlemen are now on their way to Canada for the purpose of personally inspecting Manitoba and the North-West Territory. Amongst them is Prince Hohenlohe Langenbourg. A considerable number of Germans in excess of those arriving in any previous year have settled in the country this season.

In Egypt considerable anxiety is felt regarding the prospect of the cotton crop, owing to the heavy and partially saline dew that has fallen recently. The next couple of weeks will be very critical, but should the heat continue without an increase of dew, the pods will probably be ripe in fifteen days, and a good crop may be expected.

Mr. Chamberlain has, after consultation with the Law Officers of the Crown for Scotland, decided that it would be impracticable to apply the provisions of the Fishing Boats Bill to that part of the kingdom. Scotland will, therefore, be excluded from the operations of the Bill

Twenty British and foreign actual shipwrecks were reported last week, against ten at the corresponding week of last year, making the total for the present year 1,134 as compared with 910 in 1882. British-owned vessels numbered 12; 50 lives were lost, against 18 ast year.

A few days ago, three young black storks that had been taken in the forest of Count von Bernstorff, at Trebel, near Salzwedel, in the province of Salzburg, were sent as a present to the Duke of Cumberland at Gmunden.

On Monday morning Sir Albert Woods, Garter King of Arms, placed the banner and regalia of the Duke of Grafton, one of the newly-created Knights of the Garter, in St. George's Chapel, Windsor Castle.

On Monday morning Joseph Hyde, engineer, threw himself down a pit shaft at Dudley, because he had allowed the boiler at the corporation baths to run dry. He rushed out of the boiler-house shouting "Ruin, ruin!" and at once jumped down the pit. His body was fearfully mangled. He leaves a widow and ten children.

The *Börsen Courier* states that a landed proprietor in the neighbourhood of Breslau named Schäfer first hanged his five young children and then himself.

The Guion Mail steamer *Alaska* has made another of her usual fast passages, viz., seven days forty-seven minutes. She left Queenstown on Sunday, August 12th, and arrived at New York at six a.m. on Sunday, the 19th.

The supply of live stock, &c., from the United States and Canada landed at Liverpool during last week was a slight increase on that of the preceding week, and the total arrivals amounted to 3,467 cattle, 6,761 sheep, 7,893 quarters of beef, and 555 carcases of mutton, against a total of 3,327 cattle, 5,106 sheep, 7,785 quarters of beef, and 407 carcases of mutton for the former week.

One of the New England manufacturing companies has introduced an educational qualification into its works and is said to be discharging all employés who cannot read or write. Before doing so, an opportunity was offered to all to qualify themselves, a night school being established for that purpose.

A telegram has been received by the Lords of the Admiralty stating that Prince George of Wales, in H.M.S. *Canada*, arrived at St. John's, Newfoundland, early on Monday morning, after an excellent passage from Halifax, all being well.

The number of visitors to the Fisheries Exhibition last Saturday was 20,153, making a total for last week of 100,810. The total number from the opening of the Exhibition has been 1,337,623.

The Spanish papers give details respecting the surprise and plunder of the express train near Granollers. The passengers, including several foreigners, were robbed of their money and valuables, but their luggage was left almost untouched. Thus an Englishman saved £520 which was in a box. The brigands took jewels, rings, and earrings from the ladies, but gallantly allowed them to retain a few trinkets when told they were family heirlooms, and to the poorer travellers they left a few coins each.

On Monday morning an alarming accident took place at Selly Oak, a village three miles from Birmingham. An engine and a number of carriages left the rails of the West Suburban Railway, and dashed into the parapet of a bridge which it completely demolished. The driver and stoker managed to jump from the engine, and so escaped injury. Great damage was done to property, but no one was injured

The son of a pork butcher at Birmingham has just died under peculiar circumstances. Six weeks ago he was playing with a pig, when the animal bit him in the hand. The lad was treated at the hospital, and for a time the wound seemed to be progressing satisfactorily, but symptoms of blood poisoning set in and the unfortunate boy died in great agony, frothing at the mouth.

On Sunday a heavy storm fell upon the north-west of Ontario. At Listowell there were two feet of water in the streets. At Wingham the river Maitland rose twelve feet. A railway bridge and track were washed away, and the country was covered to a depth of four feet. The standing grain was destroyed.

The weekly Parliamentary Return of Public Bills under consideration in the House of Commons during the Session of 1883, issued on Monday, shows them to have been 224 in number. Of these, up to Monday, 28 had received the Royal assent, 21 had been passed, and 36 still had to pass through one or more stages. Of the 139 lost Bills which had occupied the attention of the House of Commons, 73 had been dropped, generally after second reading, 57 had been withdrawn, and nine rejected.

In the annual statement relative to the orphan houses at Ashley Down, Bristol, it is stated that since the establishment of the institution, 6,685 bereaved persons have been under its care; five large buildings at an expense of £115,000 have been erected, and £638,339 has been given for the orphans without any appeal, but simply as the result of faith and prayer to God. The year had been commenced with 2,000 orphans and 110 helpers and a balance of only 13s. 7d., but the income had reached £28,800.

The United Steamship Association of Copenhagen has offered a free passage by their vessels to all Danish fishermen desirous of visiting the Fisheries Exhibition

In Milwaukee the cigar makers on strike have been defeated by the importation of workmen from Germany

It has been decided to hand over to the British Museum the whole of the exhibits sent from the Madras Presidency to the International Fisheries Exhibition.

On Monday a large shed used for storing flax at Dundee Harbour was burned, 150 tons of flax being destroyed. The damage is estimated at £3,600.

The Committee of the *Daphne* Disaster Fund have granted 13s. 6d. per week permanently to the fifty-four widows, and have agreed to educate their 150 children.

An earthquake has occurred at Patchusa, Mexico, causing the loss of 20 lives. A shower of thousands of fish is reported to have fallen at Montemorelas.

A severe tornado passed over Minnesota on Tuesday. The telegraph posts were levelled west and south of Minneapolis. At Kasson many of the buildings were blown down; two persons were killed and several injured. Some hailstones fell which were ten inches in circumference.

The Queen has been pleased to confer the honour of a baronetcy upon Mr. Thomas Henry Farrer, the Permanent Secretary of the Board of Trade, in recognition of his long and distinguished public service.

In London, early on Wednesday morning, a young woman, apparently about the age of 18, was observed to mount the wall of the Victoria Embankment, near the Temple Gardens, and throw herself into the Thames. She is stated to have been dressed in black, with a satin jacket, trimmed with crape.

Although a number of the colliers on strike in North Staffordshire have returned to work, several thousand men are still out, and at a meeting on Tuesday it was decided to continue the struggle.

Mangold crops throughout Cheshire are reported to have been entirely destroyed by insect pests. The insects attacked the young plants as soon as they appeared, and whole fields are barren.

The lung plague among the cattle at Salem, Massachusetts, began a month ago. It is reported that several cattle have died, having been quarantined by order of the State Commissioners.

The conscience money received by the English Chancellor of the Exchequer during the last financial year represents an unacknowledged income of £317,472.

The Lord Mayor of London has received from the Mayor of Warrnambool, Victoria, a draft for £300 for the relief of the distress in the Western Isles and Highlands of Scotland.

A boiler exploded at the Star Paper Mill, Fenniscowles, near Blackburn, on Tuesday. A man named Arnold was killed, and another man seriously injured.

A Reuter's telegram, dated Homburg, Aug. 22, says:—"The Prince of Wales left here to-day for Baden-Baden."

A fire which broke out at the Standard Oilworks on Long Island, in the City of New York, on Wednesday, caused a loss of 500,000 dols. Five men were seriously injured.

The Chinese Government, anxious to avoid any source of unpleasantness with France, has agreed to punish the murderers of a missionary in Yunnan and to grant compensation to his relatives.

Last week's receipts of cotton at all United States ports were 10,000 bales; since 1st September, 5,941,000 bales. Week's exports to Great Britain, 14,000 bales; to the Continent, 2,000 bales; total since 1st September, 4,650,000 bales. Stock at all ports, 265,000 bales.

A telegram has been received at the India Office from the Viceroy, dated Simla, August 14th, calling attention to the rapid increase of deaths from cholera at Bombay. During the fortnight ending July 7 the mortality was 32, and in the next fortnight 106, whereas for the last fortnight the deaths from cholera numbered 202.

The last four months have witnessed the development of a considerable importation of dead meat to this country from Russia, and during July £10,000 worth of fresh beef reached England from the Baltic port of Libau.

Dr. Daniel Ashbury, of North Carolina, is preparing for a public aërial ascension and sail. The two canvas wings of his flying machine stretch thirty feet broad from tip to tip, and all the man-bird has to do to regulate his flight, so the report states, is to work a pedal like that of a sewing machine.

A strike commenced on Monday amongst the tin plate workers employed at Birmingham owing to the employers attempting to reduce wages and to introduce boy labour. The men are supported by the Society, so that a protracted struggle is anticipated.

A way to measure the speed of trains is to count the number of fish plates passed in $14\frac{1}{2}$sec. in the case of ordinary rails 21ft. long, and in the case of steel rails, which average in length 30ft., $20\frac{1}{2}$sec.—the number of plates passed in the time stated being equal to the number of miles travelled per hour.

James Kelly, 23, who was sentenced to death at the last Sessions of the Central Criminal Court for the murder of his wife, Sarah Ann Kelly, and who was to have been executed last Monday morning, has, by order of the Home Secretary, been reprieved, and his sentence altered to penal servitude for life. The condemned man, who had given up all hopes of his life being spared, was informed of the fact on Saturday.

Mr. Gladstone has declined the invitation of Mr. G. Barnsley, the Master Cutler elect of Sheffield, to be present at his feast in September. The right hon. gentleman states that the orders of his physician preclude him from undertaking any duties of the nature of a public entertainment which can possibly be avoided.

On Saturday Mr. H. P. Foster, a member of the Portsmouth Town Council, was presented with a silver medal for having, a few days previously, rescued from drowning Mr. Cotton, manager to a local firm of hosiers, who suddenly became faint and sank while bathing at Southsea. Mr. Forster dived in after him, and succeeded, after much difficulty, in bringing him ashore.

The employers of the late Mr. William Spottiswoode, President of the Royal Society, have resolved to erect a monument to his memory, which will be placed in front of her Majesty's printing office in London. Mr. Belt has been commissioned to execute the work.

It is stated upon good authority that in the counties of Waterford, Tipperary, and Kilkenny there is not visible the slightest trace of potato disease, and that the crop bids fair to be one of the best and most abundant for many years.

A New York telegram says that the visible supply of wheat on Aug. 17, was 20,400,000 bushels, as against 18,800,000 bushels the previous week. Visible supply of Indian corn 10,800,000 bushels, as against 10,900,000 bushels the previous week. The export clearances of wheat for Europe during last week amounted to 1,500,000 bushels. The export clearances of Indian corn for Europe during last week amounted to 940,000 bushels.

The *Daily News* says that arrangements have been made for the issue early in the Recess of an instructive paper showing the number of days the House of Commons sat in the Session now closing, the total number of hours occupied in the sittings, and the average time, also showing the number of hours during which the House sat each day, and the number of hours after midnight.

In London, on Tuesday, a public meeting was held at the Mansion House in aid of the fund now being raised for the sufferers by the earthquake at Ischia. Resolutions were passed commending the Lord Mayor's appeal for aid to relieve the sufferers, and appointing an executive committee. Among the speakers were Sir A. Lusk, M.P., who occupied the chair, Sir Julian Goldsmid, Mr. S. Morley, M.P., Mr. Alderman Whitehead, and Mr. Vitali.

At the Liverpool Police-court, on Tuesday, James Macdermott, who a fortnight ago was arrested on board the *City of Montreal* on its arrival in Liverpool from New York, on a charge of being concerned in the dynamite conspiracy with the other men recently sentenced to penal servitude for life, was again brought up. The prosecution asked for another remand, which was granted.

A young man named Reeve, who was bathing off the Ramsgate sands on Monday, narrowly escaped drowning. He sank twice, when two gentlemen swam out to his rescue. Meanwhile, however, a bathing-machine attendant, named John Burvill, went to Reeve's assistance at the same moment, and having secured him, brought him with considerable difficulty to shore, amidst the cheers of the spectators, who raised a subscription for Burvill.

A shock of earthquake sufficiently strong to move beds and displace crockery recently occurred at Schuls, Pontresina, and Tarasp, in the Engadine. The shock was preceded by a violent storm and heralded by a peal of subterranean thunder.

The Paris *Temps* asserts that there is a woman living in the village of Auberire-en-Royans, in the department of the Isère, who was born on March 16th, 1761 and is consequently in her 123rd year. Her name is Marie Durand; she was born at St. Just-de-Claire; was married on December 30th, 1783, to Claude Girard, who was born in 1749; and she has been a widow for 96 years.

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